

The weighing of actions is a much older example of independent coincidence. Prof. Jackson¹ cites a passage from the *Çatapatha Brāhmaṇa* to show that this is "an Indian as well as an Iranian idea." This need not mean that we assign it to Aryan antiquity, though it seems to be suggested in the Gathas and is therefore very old in Iran. But some of the Old Testament parallels cited by Böklen are sheltered from suspicion of Zoroastrian influence by their very date: this must at least be true of Job 31⁶, Prov. 16², 21², 24¹². In 1 Sam. 2³ we have the same word applied to the weighing of actions, in a much older passage. But the Hebrew word seems nearer to measuring than weighing.² It is in any case a casual figure which could occur to any writer without help from a foreign literature. The really noteworthy resemblances come much later. Böklen cites the *Testament of Abraham*, which Dr M. R. James assigns to the second century A.D.³ Here we have an angel with scales, and the case of a soul whose sins and merits balance exactly, the total of each having been entered in a book. This would suit a Parsi writing very well indeed, but even here we ought to be able to support the parallel with other suggestions of borrowing before we can be sure of a real connexion.

Before I pass to the formal discussion of the problem of historical dependence, I may collect a few examples of isolated thoughts which resemble one

¹ *Actes du X. Congrès internat. des Orientalistes* (Geneva, 1894), ii. 65 ff.

² See Driver's note on 1 Sam., *l.c.*, and the *Oxford Hebrew Lexicon*, p. 1067.

³ *Texts and Studies*, II. ii. 29: the passage is on p. 90 f.—see also p. 70.